Jurassic English™

Level 3: Expansion

Curriculum Model — **10 Core Texts · 40 Lessons · Academic Year 2026–2027**

AGES 10–12 | CEFR A2 → B1 | 2026–2027

Level 3: The Pivotal Shift

The Core Transition

Level 3 introduces the pivotal shift from **"there is a right answer"** to **"there are two defensible answers, and I must choose one and justify it."**

The core texts are selected precisely because they have **ambiguous or contested endings** — not because they are difficult, but because they demand that students exercise **Interpretive Agency** for the first time.

CEIW: Full Independence

At this level, CEIW becomes **fully independent**. Scaffold support is withdrawn progressively across the year.

By the end of Level 3, students write **unscaffolded CEIW paragraphs** from a cold prompt within a single lesson — a landmark achievement in the Jurassic English™ progression.

This is the level where intellectual courage becomes a curriculum standard.

The Four-Lesson Cycle at Level 3

Each of the 10 core texts is explored through a rigorous, repeating four-lesson architecture designed to build interpretive independence.

Lesson 1: Excavation

Analyze — Deep text archaeology; authorial word choice; narrative architecture

Lesson 2: Strata

Evaluate — The Divergence Map; Socratic Seminar; Press-Extend Accountable Talk moves

Lesson 3: The Justification

Justify — Independent unscaffolded CEIW; Interpretation as the discriminating criterion

Lesson 4: The Impact

Reflect — Ecological and social connections; metacognitive self-evaluation of argument quality

Core Texts 1–5

1	**The Giver — Lois Lowry** A2–B1 · AGES 10–12 The definitive Level 3 text: a world without pain, memory, or choice. Every chapter contains a contested moral question.
2	**Tuck Everlasting — Natalie Babbitt** B1 · AGES 10–12 The morality of immortality; ecological theme (the spring, the cycle of life); ambiguous ending that demands justification.
3	**Bridge to Terabithia — Katherine Paterson** A2–B1 · AGES 10–12 Imagination as coping mechanism; loss and grief; the irreversibility of the real world vs. the permanence of metaphor.
4	**A Wrinkle in Time — Madeleine L'Engle** B1 · AGES 10–12 Physics-meets-morality; conformity and individuality; the nature of evil as "IT" — abstract antagonist.
5	**Wonder — R.J. Palacio** A2–B1 · AGES 10–11 Multiple perspectives within a single narrative; the reliability of self-perception; social belonging and exclusion.

Core Texts 6–10

1	**Island of the Blue Dolphins — Scott O'Dell** A2–B1 · AGES 10–12 Survival, ecological knowledge, and solitude; a female protagonist whose intelligence is entirely practical and ecological.
2	**The Secret Garden — Frances Hodgson Burnett** A2–B1 · AGES 10–12 Ecological healing; the garden as metaphor for psychological restoration; change as growth.
3	**Hatchet — Gary Paulsen** A2 · AGES 10–12 Ecological intelligence and survival; the wilderness as teacher; self-reliance vs. dependence.
4	**The Phantom Tollbooth — Norton Juster** B1 · AGES 10–12 Language as power; the absurdist tradition; metaphor and literalism as twin analytical tools.
5	**Roll of Thunder, Hear My Cry — Mildred D. Taylor** B1 · AGES 11–12 Social justice and systemic racism; moral courage in the face of institutionalised injustice; precursor to Level 4 complexity.

CEIW at Level 3: Full Independence

By the end of Level 3, students write **unscaffolded CEIW** from a cold prompt. All four components must be present without scaffold support — the hallmark of CEFR B1 writing.

C — Claim

A contestable position — student selects their own, no stem provided. Full ownership of the argument.

E — Evidence

Student-selected quotation with accurate page/line reference. No pre-selected quotes given.

I — Interpretation

"This suggests that..." — the formal B1 linguistic marker of interpretive reasoning.

W — Warrant

Explicitly returns to the Claim — the logical bridge that distinguishes B1 from A2 writing.

Assessment Standard: All four CEIW components present without scaffold support — assessed against the full B1 rubric.

The Divergence Map: Level 3's Signature Innovation

What Replaces the T-Chart

The Divergence Map replaces the T-chart of Level 2. Instead of FOR/AGAINST, students plot **two equally defensible positions**:

> "Position A is defensible because... Position B is also defensible because..."

The task is **NOT** to pick the winner — it is to understand **WHY both can be true simultaneously.**

The Press-Extend Move

The key Accountable Talk move at Level 3 is **Press-Extend**:

> *"But have you considered...?"*

Students must deploy this move **at least once per Socratic Seminar**, challenging a peer's position with a counter-consideration rather than a counter-claim.

Why This Matters

The Divergence Map trains students to hold intellectual tension — the foundational skill of all advanced academic reasoning and the gateway to Level 4 complexity.

Reasoning Progression at Level 3

Level 3 maps a deliberate escalation of reasoning demand across four distinct levels, culminating in the CEFR B1 exit standard.

Levels 3–4: Independent Position Formation

Students form their own position after communal evaluation — reasoning is no longer teacher-directed.

Levels 4–5: Genuine Moral Uncertainty

Students experience texts that do not resolve moral questions for them — productive discomfort as a learning tool.

Level 5: Live Argument Construction

Students construct and respond to live arguments in real time during Socratic Seminar — spontaneous reasoning under pressure.

Level 6 (Intro): Ecological Consequence

Students begin to trace the ecological consequence of social and narrative choices — bridging text and world.

Exit Standard CEFR B1: Student writes unscaffolded CEIW; forms independent position after group discussion; uses *"suggests that"* or equivalent in Interpretation.

Differentiation at Level 3

Every learner accesses the same core texts and the same intellectual challenge — differentiation adjusts the scaffold, never the cognitive demand.

Support

Pre-constructed T-chart with **3 quotes on each side** already placed. Students label and explain each quote — the interpretive work remains theirs.

Core

Independent CEIW from cold prompt. Socratic Seminar participation with Accountable Talk cards as a reference tool — not a script.

Extension

Opposing CEIW pairs — write both positions, then a final evaluative sentence identifying which is stronger and why. Plus: a **200-word op-ed** from a character's perspective.

Year at a Glance: 2026–2027

40 lessons · 10 × 4-lesson cycles — structured across three terms with a deliberate arc from scaffolded to fully independent.

Term 1

Scaffolded CEIW withdrawn progressively. Students build confidence with the Divergence Map. Accountable Talk introduced with full card support.

Term 3

Cold-prompt CEIW — fully unscaffolded. Portfolio of CEIW paragraphs assembled. Socratic Seminar participation records completed.

1 2 3

Term 2

Socratic Seminars introduced. Student-initiated regulation becomes standard. Silent observation and metacognitive preparation expected before each seminar.

Assessment

- Portfolio of unscaffolded CEIW paragraphs
- Socratic Seminar participation records
- Metacognitive self-evaluation of argument quality

Regulation Standard

By Term 2, student-initiated regulation is the norm. Students enter Socratic Seminars having completed silent observation and metacognitive preparation independently — no teacher prompt required.